Crown Claim Attachment Checklist

Get crown claims paid without a second round of paperwork

Crowns are high-fee, high-scrutiny procedures. Most attachment-related denials are avoidable with a consistent pre-submission routine. Use this before every crown claim goes out.

1. Pre-authorization

- [ ] Confirm the plan requires pre-authorization for crowns and that it was obtained before delivery.
- [ ] The authorization number, effective dates and approved tooth numbers are recorded in the chart.
- [ ] The approved code matches what you are about to bill, including any alternative benefit language.
- [ ] If the auth expired before delivery, note the reason and prepare a retro authorization request.

2. Clinical documentation

- [ ] Clinical photo of the tooth before preparation is attached and legible.
- [ ] Radiograph showing existing restoration, caries or fracture is included.
- [ ] Note states why the crown was necessary: cuspal coverage, fracture, large existing restoration, or failed restoration.
- [ ] Tooth number, material and preparation date are all written in the operatory note.

3. Code selection

- [ ] Crown code matches the material actually delivered, not the material quoted.
- [ ] Any build-up, core or post billed on the same tooth is supported by its own note.
- [ ] Temporary crown, if billed, is allowed as a separate line by this payer.
- [ ] Alternative benefit language is acknowledged so the patient estimate reflects the plan's payment, not yours.

4. Attachment hygiene

- [ ] Every attachment references the claim date of service and the tooth number.
- [ ] Files are named clearly: patient, tooth, procedure, date.
- [ ] Total attachment size is inside the payer's limit; combine pages into one PDF.
- [ ] A cover page lists what is attached so the reviewer can check it off.

5. Submit and track

- [ ] Claim and attachments transmitted together.
- [ ] Confirmation numbers saved for both claim and attachment.
- [ ] Follow-up scheduled for 14 days.
- [ ] If the claim adjudicates without the attachment, appeal immediately with proof of transmission.

Bottom line: A crown claim with a clean attachment packet usually pays on the first pass. A crown claim with a separate fax a week later usually does not.